

Charlie (Yikai) Chen

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Dietrich College → School of Computer Science, minor in Sonic Arts **Pittsburgh, PA**
Bachelor of Science, Statistics and Machine Learning → B.S. Artificial Intelligence (GPA: 3.54) **May 2029**

Selected coursework: Data Structures and Algo.s, Functional Programming, Probability Theory, Artificial Intelligence & ML I

University of California, Berkeley, College of Computing, Data Science, and Society (admitted to B.S. Statistics) **May 2025**

SKILLS

Computer and Programming Languages: Python, C++, C, SML, assembly, Java, HTML, CSS

Tools: RStudio, LaTeX, Visual Studio Code, Numpy, Jupyter, Pytorch

Language Mastery: English and Mandarin (fluent,) Spanish and Japanese (conversational)

Projects & Research

Researcher at CMU 99-520 Understanding Generative AI Literacy Development **May — August 2026**

- Collaborated on a systematic literature review of GenAI literacy (**prompt engineering**, **Zotero**, ethics, AI detection.)
- Developed review protocols, executed database searches, and performed study quality assessments.

15-122 Independent Data Structure Development — Schulte Grid **Spring 2026**

- Implemented a 2D-array-based Schulte grid interface in C with dynamic memory allocation, randomizing numbers $1 \dots n^2$ across an $n \times n$ grid and printing it into the terminal.
- Combined cognitive psychology principles with computer science concepts such as intermediate data structures, memory management, Big-O analysis, and interface construction for the final result.

TechSpark/IDeATe Woodworking, luthiery, soldering, and metal jewelry **Spring 2026 — Present**

- Independently refurbished a guitar (sanding, refinishing, soldering electronics, full setup & new hardware)
- Gained hands-on experience with woodworking tools, project fabrication, **CNC**, and **3D scanning**

Pittsburgh Pearls (Jewelry Startup Founder) **Summer 2025 — Present**

- Founded jewelry brand reimagining baroque pearls as rebellious, non-conformist; developed “break free from tradition” identity. Curated ethically sourced product line and launched direct-to-consumer platform.

Extracurriculars

Carnegie Mellon Racing, Data Analytics & Individual Projects subteam **September 2025 — Present**

- Analyze telemetry data from vehicle sensors using **Python** and **Pandas** to identify performance trends and support engineering decisions, such as aerodynamic interactions, tire degradation, and sensory data.

Artificial Intelligence Developer and Moderator at FlowGPT **August 2024 — June 2025**

- Tested AI models (context, tokens, temperature, prompt engineering); reported bugs and user feedback daily;
- moderated 30K+ user community; applied data science to improve depth and variability of responses.

UC Berkeley Academic Talent Development Program (atdp) Data Science with R **June—August 2024**

- Studied college-level inferential & computational thinking; applied **RStudio** and statistics to analyze real-world datasets.
- Completed a passion project investigating factors affecting air quality using **RStudio** and **Overleaf LaTeX**.

Audio Development Leader at EdASE by Carnegie Mellon & Clemson University **June—August 2023**

- Developed an original game with distinct levels; led design of visual and audio effects.

TA and Staff at X-Camp Programming School **December 2025 — Present**

- Support instruction in **statistical inference**, **linear algebra**, and **PyTorch** for classes CS602H and AI Olympiad–280.
- Serve as CMU alumni representative at professional meetings; coordinate with the founder (ex-Google engineer)

Lingo — Student-initiated band | Founding Bassist **August 2025 — Present**

- Co-wrote 12 original pieces; performed across Pittsburgh; featured twice on WRCT Radio.
- Bassist for Chromium (since 07/2026) + Guitarist for OneOneOne Band (since 07/2026)

CMU Tricking (Acrobatic Arts) + Swimming **August 2025 — Present**

Awards & Honors

UCSB Regents Scholar (offered to the top 3% of applicants) **Spring 2025**

Palo Alto High School Science Excellence Award for AP Chemistry **Spring 2024**

President Volunteer Service Award (PVSA) — Teens Gold (Fall 2022) + Young Adults Bronze (Fall 2024)